

REVIEW POST TRAUMATIC STRESS DISORDER (PTSD)
DISABILITY BENEFITS QUESTIONNAIRE

Name of Patient/Veteran _____

Patient/Veteran's Social Security Number _____

Date of examination: _____

IMPORTANT - THE DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS (VA) **WILL NOT PAY OR REIMBURSE** ANY EXPENSES OR COST INCURRED IN THE PROCESS OF COMPLETING AND/OR SUBMITTING THIS FORM.

Note - The Veteran is applying to the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) for disability benefits. VA will consider the information you provide on this questionnaire as part of their evaluation in processing the Veteran's claim. VA may obtain additional medical information, including an examination, if necessary, to complete VA's review of the Veteran's application. VA reserves the right to confirm the authenticity of ALL completed questionnaires. Please note that this questionnaire is for disability evaluation, not for treatment purposes. This evaluation should be based on DSM-5 diagnostic criteria. **It is intended that this questionnaire will be completed by the Veteran's healthcare provider.**

Note to examiner - The Veteran is applying to the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) for disability benefits. VA will consider the information you provide on this questionnaire as part of their evaluation in processing the Veteran's claim. Please note that this questionnaire is for disability evaluation, not for treatment purposes. This evaluation should be based on DSM-5 diagnostic criteria.

Note: If the Veteran experiences a mental health emergency during the interview, please discontinue the interview and obtain help, using local resources as appropriate. You may also contact the Veterans Crisis Line by dialing 988 and pressing 1. Stay on the Crisis Line until the Veteran is linked to emergency care.

Note: Review Posttraumatic Stress Disorder examinations must be conducted by: (1) a board-certified or board-eligible psychiatrist; (2) a licensed doctorate-level psychologist; (3) a non-licensed doctorate-level psychologist working toward licensure under close supervision; (4) a psychiatry resident under close supervision; (5) a VHA psychology trainee, under close supervision, who is completing an internship or residency for the purposes of completing a doctorate-level degree program; (6) a licensed clinical social worker (LCSW) under close supervision; or (7) a nurse practitioner, clinical nurse specialist, or physician assistant, if that individual is under close supervision and is clinically privileged by VHA to perform activities required for C&P Mental Disorders examinations.

"Under close supervision" means that the individual is supervised by a board-certified or board-eligible psychiatrist or licensed doctorate-level psychologist who must meet with the Veteran, confer with the supervised individual in providing the diagnosis and the final assessment, and co-sign the examination report.

Are you completing this Disability Benefits Questionnaire at the request of:

☐ Veteran/Claimant

☐ Third party (please list name(s) of organization(s) or individual(s))

☐ Other: please describe

Are you a VA Healthcare provider? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Is the Veteran regularly seen as a patient in your clinic? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Was the Veteran examined in person? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If no, how was the examination conducted?

SECTION 1 - DIAGNOSTIC SUMMARY

1. Diagnostic Summary

NOTE: This section should be completed based on the current examination and clinical findings.

Does the Veteran now have or has he/she ever been diagnosed with PTSD?

☐ Yes ☐ No

ICD Code: _____

If yes, continue to complete this Questionnaire.

If no diagnosis of PTSD, and the Veteran has another mental disorder diagnosis, then continue to complete this Questionnaire and/or the Eating Disorders Questionnaire

2. Current Diagnoses

2A. Mental Disorders Diagnosis #1:

ICD Code: _____

Comments, if any:

Mental Disorders Diagnosis #2:

ICD Code: _____

Comments, if any:

Mental Disorders Diagnosis #3:

ICD Code: _____

Comments, if any:

Mental Disorders Diagnosis #4:

ICD Code: _____

Comments, if any:

If additional diagnoses, describe using above format:

2B. Medical diagnoses relevant to the understanding or management of the mental health disorder (to include TBI):

ICD Code: _____

Comments, if any:

3. Differentiation of Symptoms

3A. Does the Veteran have more than one mental disorder diagnosed?

☐ Yes ☐ No If "Yes," complete Item 3B

3B. Is it possible to differentiate what symptom(s) is/are attributable to each diagnosis?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not applicable

If "No," provide reason:

If "Yes," list which symptoms are attributable to each diagnosis and discuss whether there is any clinical association between these diagnoses:

3C. Does the evidence of record show a diagnosis of Traumatic Brain Injury (TBI) for the Veteran?

☐ Yes ☐ No If "Yes," complete the following question, 3D

Comments, if any:

3D. Is it possible to differentiate what symptom(s) is/are attributable to TBI and any non-TBI mental health diagnosis?

☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not applicable

If "No," provide reason:

If "Yes," list which symptoms are attributable to TBI and which symptoms are attributable to a non-TBI mental health diagnosis:

4. Occupational and Social Impairment

4A. Which of the following best summarizes the Veteran's level of occupational and social impairment with regards to all mental diagnoses? (Check only one)

- ☐ No mental disorder diagnosis
- ☐ A mental condition has been formally diagnosed, but symptoms are not severe enough either to interfere with occupational and social functioning or to require continuous medication

- ☐ Occupational and social impairment due to mild or transient symptoms which decrease work efficiency and ability to perform occupational tasks only during periods of significant stress, or symptoms controlled by medication
- ☐ Occupational and social impairment with occasional decrease in work efficiency and intermittent periods of inability to perform occupational tasks, although generally functioning satisfactorily, with normal routine behavior, self-care and conversation
- ☐ Occupational and social impairment with reduced reliability and productivity
- ☐ Occupational and social impairment with deficiencies in most areas, such as work, school, family relations, judgment, thinking and/or mood
- ☐ Total occupational and social impairment

4B. For the indicated occupational and social impairment, is it possible to differentiate which impairment is caused by each mental disorder?

- ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not applicable

If "No," provide reason:

If "Yes," list which occupational and social impairment is attributable to each diagnosis:

4C. If a diagnosis of TBI exists, is it possible to differentiate which occupational and social impairment indicated above is caused by the TBI?

- ☐ Yes ☐ No ☐ Not applicable

If "No," provide reason:

If "Yes," list which impairment is attributable to TBI and which is attributable to any non-TBI mental health diagnosis:

SECTION 2 - CLINICAL FINDINGS

1. Evidence Review

Evidence reviewed:

- ☐ No records were reviewed
- ☐ Records reviewed

Please identify the evidence reviewed (e.g. service treatment records, VA treatment records, private treatment records) and the date range.

2. Recent History (since prior exam)

2A. Relevant social/marital/family history:

2B. Relevant occupational and educational history:

2C. Relevant mental health history, to include prescribed medications and family mental health:

2D. Relevant legal and behavioral history:

2E. Relevant substance abuse history:

2F. Other, if any:

3. PTSD Diagnostic Criteria

Please check criteria used for establishing the current PTSD diagnosis. The diagnostic criteria for PTSD, are from the Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders, 5th edition. (DSM-5). The stressful event can be due to combat, personal trauma, other life threatening situations (non-combat related stressors). Do NOT mark symptoms below that are clearly not attributable to the Criterion A stressor/PTSD. Instead, overlapping symptoms clearly attributable to other things should be noted under #6- "Other symptoms".

Criterion A: Exposure to actual or threatened a) death, b) serious injury, c) sexual violation, in one or more of the following ways:

- ☐ Directly experiencing the traumatic event(s)
- ☐ Witnessing, in person, the traumatic event(s) as they occurred to others
- ☐ Learning that the traumatic event(s) occurred to a close family member or close friend; cases of actual or threatened death must have been violent or accidental; or, experiencing repeated or extreme exposure to aversive details of the traumatic event(s) (e.g., first responders collecting human remains; police officers repeatedly exposed to details of child abuse); this does not apply to exposure through electronic media, television, movies, or pictures, unless this exposure is work related
- ☐ No criterion in this section met.

Criterion B: Presence of (one or more) of the following intrusion symptoms associated with the traumatic event(s), beginning after the traumatic event(s) occurred

- ☐ Recurrent, involuntary, and intrusive distressing memories of the traumatic event(s).
- ☐ Recurrent distressing dreams in which the content and/or affect of the dream are related to the traumatic event(s).
- ☐ Dissociative reactions (e.g., flashbacks) in which the individual feels or acts as if the traumatic event(s) were recurring. (Such reactions may occur on a continuum, with the most extreme expression being a complete loss of awareness of present surroundings.)
- ☐ Intense or prolonged psychological distress at exposure to internal or external cues that symbolize or resemble an aspect of the traumatic event(s).
- ☐ Marked physiological reactions to internal or external cues that symbolize or resemble an aspect of the traumatic event(s).
- ☐ No criterion in this section met.

Criterion C: Persistent avoidance of stimuli associated with the event(s), beginning after traumatic event(s) occurred, as evidence of one or both of the following:

- ☐ Avoidance of or efforts to avoid distressing memories, thoughts, or feelings about or closely associated with the traumatic event(s).
- ☐ Avoidance of or efforts to avoid external reminders (people, places, conversations, activities, objects, situations) that arouse distressing memories, thoughts, or feelings about or closely associated with the traumatic event(s).
- ☐ No criterion in this section met.

Criterion D: Negative alterations in cognitions and mood associated with the traumatic event(s), beginning or worsening after the traumatic event(s) occurred, as evidenced by two (or more) of the following:

- ☐ Inability to remember an important aspect of the traumatic event(s) (typically due to dissociative amnesia and not to other factors such as head injury, alcohol, or drugs).
- ☐ Persistent and exaggerated negative beliefs or expectations about oneself, others, or the world (e.g., "I am bad," "No one can be trusted," "The world is completely dangerous," "My whole nervous system is permanently ruined").
- ☐ Persistent, distorted cognitions about the cause or consequences of the traumatic event(s) that lead to the individual to blame himself/herself or others.
- ☐ Persistent negative emotional state (e.g., fear, horror, anger, guilt, or shame).
- ☐ Markedly diminished interest or participation in significant activities.
- ☐ Feelings of detachment or estrangement from others.
- ☐ Persistent inability to experience positive emotions (e.g., inability to experience happiness, satisfaction, or loving feelings.)
- ☐ No criterion in this section met.

Criterion E: Marked alterations in arousal and reactivity associated with the traumatic event(s), beginning or worsening after the traumatic event(s) occurred, as evidenced by two (or more) of the following:

- ☐ Irritable behavior and angry outbursts (with little or no provocation) typically expressed as verbal or physical aggression toward people or objects.
- ☐ Reckless or self-destructive behavior.
- ☐ Hypervigilance.
- ☐ Exaggerated startle response.
- ☐ Problems with concentration.
- ☐ Sleep disturbance (e.g., difficulty falling or staying asleep or restless sleep).
- ☐ No criterion in this section met.

Criterion F:

- ☐ Duration of the disturbance (Criteria B, C, D, and E) is more than 1 month.
- ☐ Veteran does not meet full criteria for PTSD

Criterion G:

- ☐ The PTSD symptoms described above cause clinically significant distress or impairment in social, occupational, or other important areas of functioning.
- ☐ The PTSD symptoms described above do NOT cause clinically significant distress or impairment in social, occupational, or other important areas of functioning.
- ☐ Veteran does not meet full criteria for PTSD

Criterion H:

- ☐ The disturbance is not attributable to the physiological effects of a substance (e.g., medication, alcohol) or another medical condition.
- ☐ No criterion in this section met.

4. Symptoms

For VA rating purposes, check all symptoms that apply to the Veteran's diagnoses:

- ☐ Depressed mood
- ☐ Anxiety
- ☐ Suspiciousness
- ☐ Panic attacks that occur weekly or less often
- ☐ Panic attacks more than once a week
- ☐ Near-continuous panic or depression affecting the ability to function independently, appropriately and effectively
- ☐ Chronic sleep impairment
- ☐ Mild memory loss, such as forgetting names, directions or recent events
- ☐ Impairment of short and long term memory, for example, retention of only highly learned material, while forgetting to complete tasks
- ☐ Memory loss for names of close relatives, own occupation, or own name
- ☐ Flattened affect
- ☐ Circumstantial, circumlocutory or stereotyped speech
- ☐ Speech intermittently illogical, obscure, or irrelevant
- ☐ Difficulty in understanding complex commands
- ☐ Impaired judgment
- ☐ Impaired abstract thinking
- ☐ Gross impairment in thought processes or communication
- ☐ Disturbances of motivation and mood
- ☐ Difficulty in establishing and maintaining effective work and social relationships
- ☐ Difficulty adapting to stressful circumstances, including work or a work like setting
- ☐ Inability to establish and maintain effective relationships
- ☐ Suicidal ideation
- ☐ Obsessional rituals which interfere with routine activities
- ☐ Impaired impulse control, such as unprovoked irritability with periods of violence
- ☐ Spatial disorientation
- ☐ Persistent delusions or hallucinations

- ☐ Grossly inappropriate behavior
- ☐ Persistent danger of hurting self or others
- ☐ Neglect of personal appearance and hygiene
- ☐ Intermittent inability to perform activities of daily living, including maintenance of minimal personal hygiene
- ☐ Disorientation to time or place

5. Behavioral Observations

Behavioral Observations

6. Other Symptoms

Does the Veteran have any other symptoms attributable to PTSD (and other mental disorders) that are not listed above?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If "Yes," describe:

7. Competency

NOTE: For VA purposes, a mentally incompetent person is one who because of injury or disease lacks the mental capacity to contract or to manage his or her own affairs, including disbursement of funds without limitation.

Is the Veteran capable of managing his or her financial affairs?

☐ Yes ☐ No

If "No," specify each injury or disease resulting in incompetency and provide a rationale to support this finding:

8. Remarks

Remarks, (including any testing results) if any:

SECTION 3 - EXAMINER'S CERTIFICATION AND SIGNATURE

CERTIFICATION - To the best of my knowledge, the information contained herein is accurate, complete and current.

PENALTY: The law provides severe penalties which include fine or imprisonment, or both, for the willful submission of any statement or evidence of a material fact, knowing it to be false, or for the fraudulent acceptance of any payment to which you are not entitled.

3A. Examiner's signature:

3B. Examiner's printed name and title (e.g. MD, DO, DDS, DMD, Ph.D, Psy.D, NP, PA-C):

3C. Examiner's area of practice/specialty (e.g. Cardiology, Orthopedics, Psychology/Psychiatry, General Practice):

3D. Date signed:

3E. Examiner's phone/fax numbers:

3F. National Provider Identifier (NPI) number:

3G. Medical license number and state:

3H. Examiner's address: